XOUNDRA

Product, Platform & Monetization Plan

A premium relaxation-audio platform for listening, sleep, soundscapes, and creator-led audio.

Product direction
Android first • Web checkout • Verified artists • Premium sound tools • AI mood companion

Planning document • Version 1.0 • 18 October 2026

Document purpose

This plan defines the proposed product experience, business rules, payments, roles, audio engine, premium features, creator governance, architecture, security, and staged launch plan for Xoundra. It is a build specification for product and engineering planning—not a claim that every payment route or policy exception has already been approved.

Key decisions at a glance

- **Brand:** Xoundra (working product name; complete trademark, domain, app-store and social-handle checks before public launch).
- **Platforms:** Android first, followed by a web experience.
- **Experience:** calm premium dark theme, persistent mini-player, Home / Explore / Studio / Library / Profile.
- **Accounts:** Listener and Artist. Artist status is separate from paid subscription status.
- **Monetization:** Free, Premium Monthly, Premium Annual, and a first-50 Lifetime offer; proposed prices are hypotheses pending validation.
- **Content:** verified Artists choose Free or Premium access for each track; server-side entitlement checks enforce access.
- **Payments:** native Android purchases must follow Google Play policy where applicable; Paystack card checkout is planned for the web, with local web payment options.
- **No ads at launch.**

Important policy distinction: because Xoundra sells digital subscriptions and in-app digital features, a Google Play-distributed Android app generally must use Google Play Billing unless a specific policy exception/program applies. Do not implement a Paystack web-payment link inside the Android purchase flow without confirming eligibility and the applicable Google Play rules.

1. Product vision

Xoundra helps people relax, sleep, focus, meditate, and create personal sound environments using a curated catalogue of ambient, nature, and relaxation audio. It combines a simple listener experience with creator publishing, premium soundscape mixing, scheduled listening, and an AI companion that recommends and plays existing catalogue tracks.

Product principles

- Calm, accessible, low-friction interactions; avoid noisy visual effects and excessive notifications.
- Playback reliability first: background playback, interruptions, audio focus, and offline behavior must be tested early.
- No ads at launch; revenue comes from paid subscriptions/lifetime purchases and any separately announced creator program.
- Trust and licensing: only verified Artists can publish; every track has rights, moderation, and access-tier metadata.
- Privacy by default: mood conversations and listening insights are private unless the user explicitly chooses otherwise.
- Do not market the AI as a therapist or medical treatment. It supports relaxation and sound discovery, not diagnosis.

2. Brand and visual system

Brand name: Xoundra. Suggested positioning: “Find your quiet.” Treat the name as provisional until legal and availability checks are complete.

Visual direction — Midnight Atmosphere

Token	Value	Use
Midnight Navy	#101725	Primary background and navigation
Soft Mint	#8BE1CF	Primary action, active playback, progress
Muted Lavender	#B8A9F5	AI, mood, secondary accents
Warm Amber	#F2C879	Highlights and selected emphasis
Pale Surface	#F3F6F8	Light mode surface / cards

Use generous spacing, rounded but restrained cards, clear typography, subtle waveforms, and a soft animated orb on the AI screen. Provide Light and System modes after the dark-mode foundation is stable. Animation must respect reduced-motion settings.

3. Platforms and navigation

Android is the first release target. The web version should reuse the product’s API, catalogue, account and entitlement model, but use a responsive web UI and Paystack checkout where permitted.

Navigation	Core responsibilities
Home	Continue listening, recent sounds, recommended moods, new releases, saved mixes
Explore	Search, categories, tags, artists, Free/Premium filters, curated collections
Studio	Premium soundscape mixer, saved mixes, presets; explain upgrade when locked
Library	Favourites, playlists, downloads, history, saved soundscapes
Profile	Account, subscription, settings, privacy, support; Artist dashboard appears for Artists

A persistent mini-player should show artwork, title, play/pause, and tap-through controls across main screens. The full player includes seek/progress where appropriate, queue, repeat/loop, volume and track details.

4. Accounts, permissions and roles

Role / state	Permissions
Listener	Browse, play accessible tracks, favourite, playlists, history, eligible downloads, manage own account
Premium Listener	Listener permissions plus valid Premium entitlements: mixing, saved soundscapes, sleep timer, scheduled listening, AI companion
Artist Applicant	Submit profile and rights evidence; view application status; cannot publish until approved

Role / state	Permissions
Verified Artist	All Listener features plus upload/publish approved tracks, set Free/Premium tier, view analytics, manage eligible content
Restricted / Suspended Artist	Publishing and/or monetization disabled according to documented decision; appeal path available
Admin roles	Least-privilege access: content moderation, artist review, finance, support, super-admin; all sensitive actions audited

Artist status and Premium status are separate. An Artist does not automatically receive a Premium listener entitlement, and a Premium listener is not automatically allowed to publish.

5. Catalogue and access rules

- Each audio item stores title, description, creator, duration, category, tags, language if relevant, licensing evidence, loop suitability, content status, access tier, download eligibility and media-storage references.
- Categories may include Relaxation, Sleep, Meditation, Focus, Ambient, Nature, Rain, Ocean, Forest, White Noise and other curated groupings. Tags allow one track to appear in several relevant collections without duplicating audio files.
- Every track must be approved before publication. Only Verified Artists can choose the access tier, and they choose Free or Premium during upload/edit.
- **Free track:** any signed-in or permitted guest user can listen, subject to product access rules.
- **Premium track:** only users with a valid Premium entitlement can stream or download it.
- The backend—not the app UI—must enforce access. Do not expose permanent public media URLs for Premium content; use authenticated playback authorization and short-lived signed URLs/tokens.
- Changing a track from Free to Premium or vice versa must be audited and must respect any user-facing commitments, licenses and existing commercial agreements.

6. Premium plans and the first-50 Lifetime offer

The following prices are initial proposals only. Test willingness to pay, payment fees, taxes, refunds, AI/audio delivery costs and creator economics before launch.

Plan	Proposed price	Entitlement
Free	■0	Free catalogue, standard single-track listening, basic Library
Premium Monthly	■1,500 / month	Premium catalogue plus premium features while entitlement is valid
Premium Annual	■12,000 / year	Same Premium benefits for annual billing
Founding Lifetime	■35,000 once; first 50 successful purchases	Lifetime entitlement to explicitly listed benefits, subject to clear terms and service availability

First-50 enforcement requirements

- Count only successful, verified purchases; never rely on a client-side counter.
- Use an atomic backend reservation/confirmation flow to prevent the 50th/51st race condition. If reservations are used, give them a short expiry and release abandoned reservations.

- After 50 completed qualifying purchases, permanently close the offer for new buyers and show “Founding Lifetime sold out.” Keep a durable audit record.
- Define refund, chargeback, fraud, tax, and cancellation handling before launch. A refunded/revoked purchase should not keep an active entitlement; whether the offer slot reopens is a business rule to state clearly.
- Specify exactly which current features the Lifetime purchase includes and whether future features, AI usage limits, third-party costs, or new creator tools are excluded or may require separate terms. Avoid promising every future feature forever.

7. Payments and checkout strategy

The requested product design is card-first in the Android app and a broader set of payment methods on the web. Implementation must respect platform rules as well as Paystack account configuration.

Android app — proposed card experience

- Show supported card-network marks only when they are actually available through the selected checkout provider: Visa, Mastercard, Verve (primarily Nigeria), and American Express where enabled.
- Because Xoundra’s Premium plan unlocks digital content/features, a Google Play-distributed Android app generally needs Google Play Billing for purchases unless Xoundra qualifies for an applicable exception or program. Therefore, do not assume Paystack card checkout can be embedded directly into the Play Store app.
- If Google Play Billing is used, display the payment methods supported by Google Play for the user’s device/country. Do not label this as Paystack card checkout. Confirm whether a card-network logo is supported before displaying it.
- If an approved policy exception/program applies, document eligibility, required disclosures and user-choice flows before shipping an alternative billing route.

Web checkout — Paystack

- Use Paystack Checkout with Card enabled and international payments enabled. American Express must be enabled in the Paystack dashboard and remains subject to Paystack’s supported-country and transaction rules.
- For Nigerian web customers, expose all enabled and applicable Paystack channels: Card, Pay with Bank, Bank Transfer, and USSD. The exact checkout choices depend on account configuration and Paystack availability.
- Visa and Mastercard are supported across Paystack markets; Verve is supported in Nigeria; Amex is supported for Nigeria-based merchants when activated. Paystack says Nigerian merchants cannot collect recurring subscription payments from customers using Amex, so do not rely on Amex for automatic recurring renewals. Offer a supported renewal method or a compliant alternative.
- For international customers, show international card checkout. Do not imply Nigerian USSD, Nigerian bank-account payment, or local bank transfer is globally available.
- Prices and currency: Nigerian Paystack businesses can accept NGN and, subject to the necessary setup, USD. USD payouts require a qualifying USD domiciliary account. Choose the currency strategy before displaying localized prices.

Suggested web checkout method list

Method	Who it is for	Availability note
Visa	Nigeria and international users	Eligible cards; international payments enabled for foreign-issued cards
Mastercard	Nigeria and international users	Eligible cards; international payments enabled for foreign-issued cards
Verve	Primarily Nigerian users	Paystack lists Verve for Nigeria
American Express	Eligible users internationally	Must be enabled; Nigeria-based businesses cannot use Amex for recurring subscription charges
Pay with Bank	Nigerian users	Local Nigerian bank-account checkout
Bank Transfer	Nigerian users	Paystack transfer channel for Nigerian businesses
USSD	Nigerian users	Nigerian bank USSD flow

Important: “Bank” means Paystack’s local Pay with Bank method, not a universal international bank transfer. The web checkout should present methods returned/available from Paystack rather than hard-coding options that may not be enabled for a particular transaction.

Suggested app copy — only use if permitted by Google Play policy

“Prefer another payment method? Visit Xoundra on the web to see available payment options.”

For a Play-distributed app selling digital Premium access, Google generally prohibits in-app links or wording that steers users to an alternate payment method unless an applicable policy exception/program allows it. Until eligibility is confirmed, do not place the web link or this call-to-action in the Android purchase flow. It may be used in permitted off-app communications, and a web link can be shown only in a compliant context.

Website URL placeholder: https://YOUR-XOUNDRA-DOMAIN.example (replace with the verified production domain before release). Do not ship a guessed or temporary domain.

8. Payment processing and entitlement security

- Never trust a client-side “payment successful” screen. Verify transactions server-side with the provider and signed webhook events.
- Maintain a central entitlement record with user, product/plan, provider, provider transaction/subscription IDs, start/end timestamps, status, refund/revocation state and audit metadata.
- Handle pending, successful, failed, expired, cancelled, refunded, charged-back and renewed states idempotently.
- For Google Play, validate purchase tokens on the backend and reconcile subscription lifecycle events. Provide restore/manage subscription paths as required.
- For Paystack web payments, use verified transaction status and webhook processing; avoid duplicate entitlement grants on repeated callbacks.
- Separate a one-time Lifetime entitlement from subscription renewal logic. Apply server-side concurrency controls to the first-50 offer.
- Keep secret API keys on the server; never bundle Paystack secret keys or privileged database credentials in the mobile app.

9. Audio playback engine

Build and test a playback prototype before committing to the complete UI. The app needs three distinct playback modes coordinated by one playback manager.

Mode	Behavior
Single sound	Play one track; support pause/resume, progress where appropriate, loop and track details
Sequential playlist	Play queue items in order; next/previous, shuffle where appropriate, repeat queue
Concurrent soundscape	Mix multiple tracks simultaneously with independent gain/volume and master volume; Premium only

- Android background playback service and media session; lock-screen and notification controls; headset/Bluetooth controls where supported.
- Handle audio focus, calls, interruptions, route changes, app backgrounding, process recreation and device restart as appropriate.
- Use a native-capable playback implementation for concurrent mixing; validate simultaneous streams, CPU/battery, memory, fades, looping and background behavior on real Android devices.
- Downloads must be encrypted or access-controlled where practical and respect licensing; remove or disable content when the user loses access where required by the content agreement.
- Provide playback error recovery, retry behavior and clear offline/streaming indicators.

10. Premium feature — Soundscape Studio

- Premium-only feature. Free users can listen to an individual Free track, but cannot create or save concurrent mixes.
- Add, remove, replace and reorder sound layers; adjust per-track volume; mute/unmute; master volume; loop/fade controls.
- Save, rename, duplicate and delete soundscapes; offer curated presets such as Rainy Evening, Deep Focus, Forest Calm and Night Ocean.
- Saved mixes store track IDs, layer order, gain, loop/fade settings and versioned metadata—not copies of source files.
- At playback time, re-check entitlement and every component track’s access/download rights. Offline mix playback is available only when all component tracks are eligible and downloaded.
- If a mix contains a Premium track and the user’s entitlement expires, explain which layer is locked and offer a clear route to restore access.

11. Premium feature — Sleep Timer and Scheduled Listening

These are two related but different features and should have separate controls.

Sleep Timer

- Stop after a selected duration, at the end of the current track, or fade out over a chosen interval.
- Display remaining time and a clear cancel/edit action. Timer should apply to the active playback session and behave predictably across app backgrounding.

Scheduled Listening

- Let users choose a start time, repeat days, selected track or saved soundscape, duration and optional fade-in/volume.
- Schedule locally on Android where appropriate, with permission explanations and a fallback when exact scheduling is unavailable.
- Exact alarms are restricted on recent Android versions and may require special access. Do not promise the sound will always start: force-stop, revoked permissions, device restrictions, reboot behavior, battery-saving modes, offline files and OS policy can affect delivery.
- Ask for the minimum permissions needed. If the user selects a streaming track but may be offline at the scheduled time, recommend downloading eligible audio first.
- Persist schedules, restore them after reboot when permitted, and show the user when a schedule cannot run.

UX wording: “Scheduled listening may require Android alarm permission. It may not run if the app is force-stopped or required permissions are disabled.”

12. Premium feature — AI Mood Listening Companion

The AI companion is a guided sound-discovery experience, not a general medical or therapy product. It must choose from Xoundra’s actual catalogue and never invent a track or claim it has started audio before playback is confirmed.

Example interaction

1. User taps AI → opens a dedicated screen with a gently animated orb.
2. AI greets the user: “Hello, [first name]. How are you feeling today? You can tell me out loud or type a message.”
3. User speaks or types: “I’ve had a stressful day.”
4. AI responds: “That sounds like a tiring day. Let’s make things a little quieter. I’ll look for gentle rain and soft nighttime ambience. You can tell me if you’d prefer something different.”
5. The backend searches real catalogue tracks, ranks eligible options, and asks the player to start the selected sound(s).
6. The user can pause, stop, skip, adjust volume, type/speak a new mood, or ask for a different atmosphere.

Screen states and controls

- Orb states: idle, listening, processing, speaking, selecting sound, playing, paused and error. State must match actual microphone/playback status.
- Offer voice and text input; provide text fallback if microphone access or speech recognition is unavailable.
- Request microphone permission only when the user chooses voice input; provide a visible mute/stop control and explain when audio is being captured.
- Use server-side catalogue search/ranking with access checks. Return track IDs and reasons grounded in metadata, then pass them to the playback service.
- Premium entitlement and usage limits must be checked server-side. Establish a budget/rate limit for AI voice, speech recognition and text-to-speech costs.
- Protect sensitive mood conversations; define retention, deletion, provider processing and privacy disclosures before launch.
- Avoid diagnosis, treatment claims, crisis handling beyond an appropriate safety response, or manipulative emotional dependency. Keep the user in control.

13. Artist verification and publishing

Proposed verification criteria

- Complete email verification and required profile details; phone verification can be added where justified.
- Submit evidence of ownership or distribution rights for each uploaded track, including relevant licenses for samples, loops, field recordings and collaborative works.
- Pass audio-quality review: no corrupt files, unacceptable clipping/noise, misleading metadata or prohibited content.
- Accept the Artist Agreement, content standards, copyright takedown process, privacy terms and any creator earning/payout terms.
- Complete identity, tax or payout checks appropriate to the chosen monetization model and legal requirements.
- Human admin review and documented decision. A suggested initial review batch of three representative tracks may help assess quality, but this is a configurable product policy, not a universal requirement.

Artist application states

Applicant → Under review → Verified / Rejected (with reason) → Restricted or Suspended when necessary. Provide a documented appeal route. Only Verified Artists can publish and choose Free/Premium access. Serious copyright, fraud or policy violations may lead to restrictions or revocation after review.

Creator earnings

Do not promise automatic payment per raw play. Before launching payouts, define a transparent model, eligible engagement signals, fraud controls, minimum payout thresholds, reporting periods, payment fees, tax obligations, disputes and payout schedules. With no ads at launch, creator revenue must be funded by a clearly defined subscription/content pool, direct support model, or other explicit revenue source.

14. Library, search, offline and personalization

- Library: favourites, playlists, listening history, downloads and saved soundscapes.
- Search by title, artist, category, tag, mood, duration and access tier. Offer useful filters and empty states.
- Personalized recommendations may use explicit mood preferences and listening behavior; explain controls and allow history clearing where feasible.
- Private listening insights should be opt-in or clearly explained. Avoid public mood or health inferences.
- Offline downloads must show size, availability and removal controls. Only download tracks the user is licensed and entitled to access.

15. Admin and moderation console

Build a secure web admin console with role-based access and an audit log. Suggested areas:

- Artist applications, identity/rights evidence, approval decisions and appeals.
- Track review queue, reports, takedowns, metadata editing, tier changes and licensing expiry.
- Subscription and entitlement lookup, transaction reconciliation, refunds/revocations, first-50 Lifetime counter.
- Support tickets, user safety reports, account restrictions and controlled access to user data.
- Analytics: catalogue listening, track completion, searches, retention, conversion, subscription churn and error rates.

- Finance: revenue reconciliation and, only after creator payouts are defined, creator balances and payout approvals.

All privileged actions should be logged with actor, timestamp, target, reason and before/after values where appropriate. Support staff should not have unrestricted access to private AI conversations.

16. Recommended technical architecture

Recommended starting point: React Native + Expo with JavaScript for the Android client, a native-capable audio playback layer, and a backend that owns authentication, catalog access, purchases and entitlements. Validate Expo/native module compatibility for background playback and concurrent mixing before locking the stack.

Layer	Recommendation / responsibility
Android app	React Native + Expo; navigation, player UI, local schedules, downloads and client state
Audio layer	Native-capable playback service/media session; test concurrent audio and lifecycle behavior early
Backend	Supabase/PostgreSQL/Auth/Storage/Edge Functions or a dedicated API; server-side policies and webhook handling
Database	Relational model for users, artists, tracks, tags, playlists, soundscapes, plans, purchases, entitlements and audits
Storage/CDN	Private object storage, signed access, controlled download URLs, rights-aware delivery
AI service	Server-side model/voice integration; catalogue-grounded retrieval; rate limits and cost monitoring
Payments	Google Play Billing for Play-distributed digital purchases unless an exception applies; Paystack web checkout
Web	Next.js or equivalent responsive site using the same API and entitlement rules
Observability	Crash reporting, structured logs, playback analytics, billing alerts, audit trails

Suggested core entities

users, artist_profiles, artist_applications, tracks, track_assets, categories, track_tags, soundscapes, soundscape_layers, playlists, playlist_tracks, favorites, listening_history, plans, purchases, subscriptions, entitlements, downloads, scheduled_sessions, ai_sessions (minimal metadata only), creator_earnings, payouts, reports, moderation_actions, admin_audit_logs.

17. Security, privacy and compliance

- Enforce row-level access policies and server-side authorization for user records, media, artist uploads, entitlements and admin actions.
- Validate uploaded file type, size, duration and metadata; scan files where practical; limit abuse and storage costs.
- Use secure token storage, short-lived media URLs, rate limiting, input validation and secret management.
- Set up privacy policy, terms of service, subscription terms, refund/cancellation information, Artist Agreement, copyright/takedown process and AI disclosure before launch.
- Provide account deletion and relevant data export/deletion workflows consistent with applicable law and store requirements.
- Define data retention for listening history, voice/text conversations, moderation evidence, billing logs and creator tax records.

- Test payment fraud, webhook replay, duplicate callbacks, access expiry, account takeover and Premium URL sharing.

18. Analytics and success measures

Area	Metrics
Activation	Sign-up completion, first-play conversion, time to first sound
Listening	Listening minutes, completion, return sessions, playback failure rate
Retention	Day 1 / Day 7 / Day 30 retention, weekly active listeners, churn
Monetization	Free-to-Premium conversion, renewal rate, refund/chargeback rate, revenue after fees
Catalogue	Search success, favourite rate, repeat listening, Free vs Premium engagement
Creator ecosystem	Application-to-verification rate, approval time, takedown rate, creator retention
Reliability	Crash-free sessions, background playback success, schedule delivery, download failures
AI	User-rated usefulness, successful catalogue match, playback start rate, cost per session, safety reports

19. Development roadmap

Phase	Scope	Exit criteria
P0 — Foundation	Brand validation, requirements, schema, auth, API, permissions, Android audio prototype	Single/playlist/background playback works on real devices; security baseline agreed
P1 — Listener core	Home, Explore, search, player, queue, Library, favourites, history	Core flows usable; telemetry and error handling present
P2 — Monetization	Plan setup, Google Play Billing, web Paystack checkout, entitlement service, first-50 offer	Server verification, renewals, refunds, concurrency and policy review tested
P3 — Premium audio	Mixer, saved soundscapes, Sleep Timer, Scheduled Listening	Mixing, lifecycle, alarm permission and offline edge cases validated
P4 — AI companion	Voice/text conversation, catalogue retrieval, playback handoff, budgets	Catalogue-grounded results, privacy controls and safe fallback tested
P5 — Artist ecosystem	Applications, verification, upload, moderation, Free/Premium tiers, analytics, admin	Rights workflow and access control verified end-to-end
P6 — Release readiness	QA, accessibility, security, legal/policy review, store assets, support processes	Release checklist signed off; monitoring and rollback ready
P7 — Web expansion	Responsive web, account management, Paystack payment options, SEO/public catalogue	Web purchases reconcile to same backend entitlements

Do not build all features in one pass. Prove playback and entitlement security early; these are foundational to the product.

20. QA and acceptance checklist

- Free track plays for eligible users; Premium track is denied when entitlement is absent/expired.

- Only Verified Artists can publish and set access tiers; every tier change is audited.
- Lifetime purchase count cannot exceed 50 successful qualifying purchases under concurrent traffic.
- Failed, pending, refunded and charged-back purchases do not incorrectly grant lasting Premium access.
- Background playback and media controls work across screen lock, notifications, audio focus loss and common device vendors.
- Concurrent soundscape playback supports independent volumes, fade and loop without severe clipping or instability.
- Sleep Timer stops/fades at the selected time; scheduled listening handles permission denial, reboot, offline state and unsupported exact alarms gracefully.
- AI can use voice or text, displays correct states, selects only existing accessible tracks and stops promptly on request.
- Web checkout presents only methods available for the merchant and transaction; webhook processing is idempotent.
- Privacy, accessibility, account deletion, moderation appeals and support paths are tested.

21. Open decisions before development

- Confirm public brand availability for Xoundra: trademark search, domain, Google Play listing, social handles and app-store conflicts.
- Approve or revise proposed pricing; define taxes, regional pricing, refunds and whether prices include applicable taxes.
- Confirm exact Google Play payment route and any applicable alternative-billing/ external-offer program eligibility before adding web-payment links to the Android app.
- Choose production web domain and configure secure checkout return URLs.
- Decide whether Free users can listen without an account and which downloads are available by plan.
- Finalize Artist Agreement, licensing rules, moderation SLAs and creator earnings model before accepting public creators.
- Set AI session limits, privacy retention, model/voice providers and cost budget.
- Choose supported Android versions/devices and exact alarm behavior/permission policy.
- Define customer support, dispute handling, content takedowns and operational ownership.

22. Official references

Paystack — Payment Channels
https://paystack.com/docs/payments/payment-channels/
Card networks and country-specific methods; Nigerian Bank/USSD/transfer availability.

Paystack Support — Pay with card
https://support.paystack.com/en/articles/2128258
International cards and Amex activation; Amex recurring-payment limitation for Nigeria.

Paystack Support — International payments
https://support.paystack.com/en/articles/2130690
International-payment enablement, currencies, fees and USD payout requirements.

Google Play — Payments policy overview
https://support.google.com/googleplay/android-developer/answer/10281818?hl=en
Digital subscriptions/features generally require Google Play Billing unless policy exceptions apply.

Android Developers — Schedule alarms
https://developer.android.com/develop/background-work/services/alarms
Android alarm scheduling considerations.

Android Developers — Exact alarm permission changes
https://developer.android.com/about/versions/14/changes/schedule-exact-alarms
Exact alarm access and permission behavior on Android 14+.

End of plan • Xoundra • Version 1.0